



Always look out for the typical style in scam emails

solicitations with skepticism, since there's no way to avoid receiving these mails. If you didn't remember signing up for a service or contest, then you probably didn't. Reputable financial institutions never prompt you for account information via email, but if you're unsure about whether you need to provide extra info to a company you deal with, always contact them directly.

Another kind of hoax is the infamous chain letter. These try to persuade the recipient to forward the letter to as many people as possible by using emotional stories or get-rich-quick schemes. There's also the threat of physical violence or bad luck if one attempts to break the chain. It can often become difficult to tell the difference between chain letters and real correspondence, since it's not uncommon for people to treat it like a game. Chain letters are widely popular on sites such as Orkut and Youtube, with some comments prompting the user to copy and paste a link to get secret information. Naturally, you should never follow such links nor open any attachments that come with chain letters since they can contain trojans.

2.3 Identifying scams

Hoaxes attempt to fool people into dropping some cash. Scams can be a lot more dangerous, since they attempt to obtain all